

Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document

Positioning thesis

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deeper professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automation, accessibility, and file-format control.

Prepared for	Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers
Prepared by	Microsoft Word capability team
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Tip: In Word, right-click the Table of Contents and choose “Update Field” to refresh page numbers.

1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility, and integration across Microsoft 365.

- Parity: real-time coauthoring, comments, @mentions, sharing links, version history, autosave, templates, spelling/grammar help, and web access.
- Word advantage: Track Changes controls, compare/combine, mail merge, advanced styles, captions/cross-references, indexes, custom fields, content controls, macros/add-ins, protected documents, sensitivity labels, and richer desktop publishing features.
- Enterprise advantage: integration with SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, Purview, Copilot, Outlook, Excel, PowerPoint, Power Automate, and Microsoft security/compliance workflows.

3. Capability matrix: Word has all the expected basics plus professional depth

Capability	Google Docs expectation	Microsoft Word answer	Word advantage
Real-time coauthoring	Multiple users edit in a browser	Coauthoring in Word desktop/web when stored in OneDrive/SharePoint	Collaboration with desktop-grade layout and review controls
Comments & mentions	Comments, suggestions, action items	Threaded comments, @mentions, tasks, resolved threads	Integrated with Outlook/Teams/Microsoft 365 identity
Change review	Suggesting mode	Track Changes: insertions, deletions, formatting, reviewer identity, accept/reject, lock tracking	More formal review workflow for legal, editorial, regulated documents
Version history	Restore prior versions	Version history through OneDrive/SharePoint; local file versioning options	Cloud + enterprise repositories + records processes
Long documents	Headings, outline, basic TOC	TOC, captions, cross-references, indexes, bibliography, fields, master-document practices	Better for reports, contracts, manuals, theses
Formatting/design	Basic styles/tables/images	Advanced styles, themes, columns, section breaks, page setup, watermarks, object placement	Higher-fidelity professional output
Mail merge	Requires add-ons/workarounds	Native mail merge with Excel/Outlook data	Production-ready personalized letters, labels, envelopes, email merges
Automation	Apps Script/add-ons	VBA macros, Office Scripts ecosystem	Broader enterprise automation surface